

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

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BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

4 February 2021

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING:
RECORD OF DISCUSSION

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel Eric Charron
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Retired Rep	Brigadier-General William 'Bill' Richard (Retired)
Member / Serving Rep	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin
Member / Foundation President	Colonel Steve Sibbald (Retired)
Member / CO Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Walter Gamblin
Member / Honorary Rep	Lieutenant-Colonel Ken Lloyd
Member / Signaller's Club	Major Mike DeNoble (Retired)
Branch Adjutant (Secretariat)	Major Blair Christie

SUMMARY OF DISCUSSION

- Purpose of this engagement is to ensure that everyone is working from same *sheet of music*.
- Senate Charter and Strategic Guidance released for discussion.
- Senate Policy #1 also provides guidance on Family Strategic Planning and Business Planning process.
- Goal of Family governance framework was to co-ord and co-operate plus provide oversight of fin plans to ensure we could afford what initiatives go forth.
- All agreed that '*Governance is embryonic, we have not gone thru a full cycle needed to review, create a BP, etc.*'. We have a system, but a full cycle will allow us to evaluate and modify as needed. The spirit of framework is to share across our entities.
- Issues with 17th May plan for Museum anniversary celebrations must be discussed. Foundation is working hard on ideas for fund-raising and celebrating the anniversary of the Museum. Branch & Association was not tracking. The question was asked as to whether we need to focus on the 17th of May, or can we group the anniversary in into C&E Week? The 17th is just a date.
- **LCol Gamblin** pointed out that we don't know if we're trying to bite off more than we can chew. Plan could be entirely manageable. Thus far, no concrete visibility, no consensus ... this uncertainty has created the concern among various Senate members.
- The Stream-a-thon has a very broad scope and caught many off-guard. It was pointed out that the Senate should have been made aware of the thinking behind plan as it unfolded. While the Family governance framework is still emergent, the hope was that the spirit of the governance would be followed. The goal of the framework was coordination and cooperation which seems to have been missed with these latest initiatives.

COLONEL SIBBALD (RETIRED)

- Stream-a-thon surfaced when Karen Young & Pete Scott discussed the Colonel Arthur J.E. Child Building opening plus the opening of the previous museum (on / around similar date of 17 May).
- New building is now 25 YO. Online telethon idea arose as a means to celebrate, attract attention, and generate funding.
- Mr. Scott identified video archives, by many volumes, locked up in a filing cabinet.
- Purpose of plan is to digital broadcast these archives – such as David Hart footage – as a means to *wave the flag* of the museum and highlight efforts on Digital Collection Management (DCM).
- Concur that plan could entail a lot of work but D&G was to reduce workload and simplify the plan. Most of the telethon work would be pre-recorded but we would need someone to run the system to keep materials online and presented, and monitor means provided to collect money.

LIEUTENANT-COLONEL LLOYD

- His experience with VST showed that if you can show value to the targeted community then donations won't be a problem.
- He offered the assistance of the Vintage Signals Team's experience and hoped to establish stronger linkages between VST and Museum.

LIEUTENANT-COLONEL GAMBLIN

- Vintage Signals Team (VST) = excellent engagement strategy that should be pursued.
- The lack of a functioning Museum Committee has contributed to the current problem:
 - The Committee would have been the right vehicle to bridge the Stream-a-thon event with the Foundation and Museum staff. Cmdt not there to interject / control / temper expectations, and no committee to box-in and scope ideas.
 - In addition, stream-a-thon entails an 8 hour event, Museum looking to a ribbon-cutting idea, with a concert planned days earlier. These were all separate plans conceived in bubbles. The museum committee could scope and link everything together.Momentums are well-intentioned, but are not in alignment.
- CMCEN Calendar ... Major meetings and engagements should be captured. CMCEN needs be more than retirements.

MAJOR-GENERAL LEECH (RETIRED)

- Have not seen stream-a-thon CONOPs but is concerned that without proper coordination we have each Family entity competing for resources or the same sources – corporate or individual members.

MAJOR DENOBLE (RETIRED)

- From experience: a Concert to celebrate an anniversary / millstone did not work well in the past.
- From the Signallers' Club:
 - No one bought tickets for a concert-type event.
 - Recruitment numbers are very low, despite that membership is free for retired members.
 - Access to museum remains problematic (can't access resources).
- Suggested that a more refined event might be more appropriate for 17 May.

BRIGADIER-GENERAL LAMBERT

- 1st – Solid **Governance** is nascent and we must continue to build upon it and refine it.
- 2nd – stream-a-thon + other **fast-approaching initiatives**: afraid that they were disjointed and running out of time, hence rushing to failure. We will not expend public funds or pers to support: No legal grounds to support given the current state of affairs. Personally not comfortable with 17th May and is receptive to push a properly scoped plan to launch during C&E Week as an event.

SUMMARY

- Upcoming BoD will have an initial back-brief on 17th May regarding the Museum's 25th anniversary plans. Decision will be made as to continue planning and execution or to delay events.
- Briefing to BoD will include Foundation plan so that initiatives for the Museum anniversary are joint with due consideration for financial support, staffing, and admin requirements included.
- It was agreed that these events would focus on the C&E community ... leave out players not involved with the C&E Family (i.e. political sphere, etc.).
- **It was also agreed to include Family meeting information would be posted on CMCEN Calendar (Action Item for Branch Adjutant).**



Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Colonel Commandant

LAMBERT, JAMES 738

Digitally signed by LAMBERT,
JAMES 738
Date: 2021.02.15 10:00:05 -05'00'

Brigadier-General James Lambert
Branch Leader